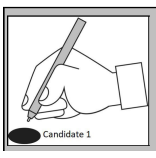
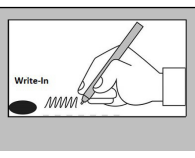
State of Rhode Island Official Ballot
General Election
November 3, 2026
North Smithfield

Precinct 2501
Congressional District 1
Senate District 17
Representative District 48



TO MARK YOUR CHOICE
Fill in the oval to the left of your choice.
Do not make any marks outside of the oval.



TO VOTE FOR A WRITE-IN CANDIDATE
To vote for a candidate whose name is not on the ballot. Fill in the oval to the left of "Write-in" and print the name clearly in the box.

Senator in Congress
Six Year Term
Vote for 1

- ⬭ **Raymond T. McKay** REPUBLICAN
- ⬭ **John F. Reed** DEMOCRAT
- ⬭ **Michael Bahry** Independent
- ⬭ **Write-in**

Representative in Congress
District 1
Two Year Term
Vote for 1

- ⬭ **Kellie Keenan** REPUBLICAN
- ⬭ **Gabriel Amo** DEMOCRAT
- ⬭ **Pedro DeSouza** Independent
- ⬭ **Write-in**

Governor
Four Year Term
Vote for 1

- ⬭ **Aaron C. Guckian** REPUBLICAN
- ⬭ **Helena Buonanno Foulkes** DEMOCRAT
- ⬭ **Kenneth Block** Independent
- ⬭ **Jasjit S. Gotra** Independent
- ⬭ **C. D. Reynolds** Independent
- ⬭ **Write-in**

Lieutenant Governor
Four Year Term
Vote for 1

- ⬭ **John J. Loughlin, II** REPUBLICAN
- ⬭ **Sabina Matos** DEMOCRAT
- ⬭ **Write-in**

Secretary of State
Four Year Term
Vote for 1

- ⬭ **Gregg M. Amore** DEMOCRAT
- ⬭ **Write-in**

Attorney General
Four Year Term
Vote for 1

- ⬭ **Alan Leonard Gordon** REPUBLICAN
- ⬭ **Kimberly Ahern** DEMOCRAT
- ⬭ **Write-in**

General Treasurer
Four Year Term
Vote for 1

- ⬭ **Micholas A. Credle** REPUBLICAN
- ⬭ **James A. Diossa** DEMOCRAT
- ⬭ **Write-in**

Senator in General Assembly
District 17
Two Year Term
Vote for 1

- ⬭ **Thomas J. Paolino** REPUBLICAN
- ⬭ **Nelly Burdette** DEMOCRAT
- ⬭ **John Douglas Barr, II** Independent
- ⬭ **Jina N. Petrarca** Independent
- ⬭ **Write-in**

Representative in General Assembly
District 48
Two Year Term
Vote for 1

- ⬭ **Brian C. Newberry** REPUBLICAN
- ⬭ **Write-in**

Non-Partisan Town Council
Two Year Term
Vote for up to 5

- ⬭ **Kevin Carriere**
- ⬭ **Rebecca J. DeCristofaro**
- ⬭ **Ann Fieler Lilley**
- ⬭ **Sean M. Fuller**
- ⬭ **Paul Jones**
- ⬭ **Elizabeth W. Newberry**
- ⬭ **Michael R. Plante**
- ⬭ **David J. Punchak**
- ⬭ **Write-in**
- ⬭ **Write-in**
- ⬭ **Write-in**
- ⬭ **Write-in**
- ⬭ **Write-in**

Non-Partisan School Committee
Four Year Term
Vote for up to 2

- ⬭ **Teresa Bartomioli**
- ⬭ **Mark Fasano**
- ⬭ **Gabriella Stelle**
- ⬭ **Write-in**
- ⬭ **Write-in**

SAMPLE

Voting continues on back

State Questions

QUESTIONS 1 - 5
(Chapter 084 Public Laws 2026)

Shall the act passed by the General Assembly at the January 2026 session, allowing the State of Rhode Island to issue bonds, refunding bonds, and temporary notes to pay for the projects listed below, be approved, and the State be allowed to issue these bonds, refunding bonds, and temporary notes as outlined in the law?

1. HIGHER EDUCATION FACILITIES - $275,000,000

For capital improvements to higher education facilities, to be allocated as follows:

a. University of Rhode Island Integrated Health Building - $165,000,000

b. Rhode Island College Adams Library Renovations - $50,000,000

c. Community College of Rhode Island Workforce Innovation Center - $60,000,000

⬭ **Approve**
⬭ **Reject**

2. HOUSING AND HOMEOWNERSHIP - $120,000,000

To increase and preserve the availability of affordable and accessible housing to meet the needs of all Rhode Islanders and support community revitalization through the redevelopment of existing structures, new construction, property acquisition, and infrastructure improvements. Of this amount, at least twenty-five million dollars ($25,000,000) shall be allocated towards increasing production of housing intended for homeownership and up to ten million dollars ($10,000,000) may be used to support a program for public housing development.

⬭ **Approve**
⬭ **Reject**

3. ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT - $100,000,000

To fund site development and growth industry infrastructure for economic development purposes, to be allocated as follows:

a. Site Development - $55,000,000

b. Growth Industry Infrastructure - $45,000,000

⬭ **Approve**
⬭ **Reject**

4. CULTURAL ECONOMY - $50,000,000

To provide funding for cultural economy efforts, to be allocated as follows:

a. State History Center - $45,000,000

b. State Preservation Grants Program - $5,000,000

⬭ **Approve**
⬭ **Reject**

State Questions

5. GREEN ECONOMY BONDS - $55,000,000

For environmental and recreational purposes, to be allocated as follows:

a. Brownfields Remediation and Economic Development - $3,000,000

b. Facility Improvements - $12,000,000

c. Local Recreation Projects - $1,000,000

d. Marine Infrastructure Development - $1,000,000

e. Resilient Rhody Infrastructure Fund - $25,000,000

f. Narragansett Bay Watershed Restoration - $7,000,000

g. Agricultural Land Preservation Commission - $3,000,000

h. Open Space Program - $3,000,000

⬭ **Approve**
⬭ **Reject**

Local Questions

Questions 6-15

Amendments to the North Smithfield Home Rule Charter
(Resolution of the Town Council adopted June 25 and July 20, 2026)

6. TOWN COUNCIL TERMS
(Article II, § 2 and Article IV, § 1)

Shall the North Smithfield Home Rule Charter be amended to modify **Article II, Section 2** and **Article IV, Section 1** to provide that, commencing December 1, 2028:

- The Town Council shall consist of five (5) members elected at-large at regular biennial elections in even-numbered years. Except as provided below for the 2028 regular election, each member shall serve a four-year term and until a successor is elected and qualified, and at each regular election only those seats whose terms are expiring shall be filled;
- At the 2028 regular election only, the three (3) candidates receiving the highest number of votes shall be elected to four-year terms expiring December 1, 2032, and the two (2) candidates receiving the next highest number of votes shall be elected to two-year terms expiring December 1, 2030, so that Town Council terms are staggered thereafter;
- The existing Charter provision limiting elected officials to eight (8) consecutive years in the same elected office shall remain in effect;
- A person who has served eight (8) consecutive years in the same elected office shall remain ineligible to seek election to that office until at least four (4) years have elapsed following the expiration of such service; and
- As a one-time transition to staggered Town Council terms, any Town Council member elected in 2028 shall be permitted to serve the full term to which elected notwithstanding the eight-consecutive-year limitation, and any Town Council member elected to a two-year term in 2028 shall be eligible to seek election to a four-year Town Council term at the 2030 regular election, with such two-year term not counted toward the Charter's eight-consecutive-year limitation?

Explanation:
This amendment would modify Articles II and IV of the Home Rule Charter.

The amendment would establish staggered four-year terms for members of the Town Council beginning December 1, 2028. At the 2028 regular election, the three candidates receiving the highest number of votes would

Continued From Previous Column

serve four-year terms ending in 2032 and the two candidates receiving the next highest number of votes would serve two-year terms ending in 2030. Thereafter, all Town Council seats would be filled for staggered four-year terms, with three seats elected in 2032 and every four years after that, and two seats elected in 2030 and every four years after that.

The amendment would retain the existing Charter provision limiting elected officials to eight consecutive years in the same elected office and would continue to require a four-year break in service before a person who has reached that limit may again seek election to the same office.

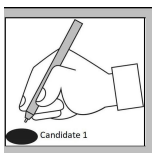
The amendment would also establish a one-time transition provision to implement staggered Town Council terms. Under this provision, any Town Council member elected in 2028 would be permitted to complete the term to which elected even if such service would otherwise exceed the Charter's eight-consecutive-year limitation. In addition, a Town Council member elected to a two-year transitional term in 2028 would be eligible to seek election to a four-year term in 2030, and the transitional two-year term would not be counted toward the Charter's eight-consecutive-year limitation.

⬭ **Approve**
⬭ **Reject**

Voting continues on the next page

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Local Questions

7. PERSONNEL BOARD DUTIES AND RESPONSIBILITIES
(Article XIII, § 1)

Shall the Home Rule Charter of the Town of North Smithfield be amended by revising Article XIII, Section 1 (Personnel Board) to remove the existing prohibition that members "shall not hold or be a candidate for any other public office or position" and related political activity restrictions, and to instead provide that Personnel Board members shall not hold or be candidates for elective office within the Town of North Smithfield, with resignation required upon candidacy, while permitting such members to hold or seek elective office in other municipalities or at the state or federal level as allowed by Rhode Island law and also be amended to reflect the accuracy of the current duties of the Personnel Board which have been modified since the last update?

Explanation:
This amendment would update Article XIII, Section 1 of the Charter governing the Personnel Board by:

- Removing the current blanket prohibition on holding or being a candidate for any public office and certain political activities;
- Replacing it with a narrower restriction prohibiting Personnel Board members from holding or running for elective office within the Town of North Smithfield;
- Requiring resignation from the Board if a member becomes a candidate for Town elective office;
- Allowing members to hold or seek elective office in other municipalities or at the state or federal level, consistent with Rhode Island law;
- The duties of the Personnel Board have been updated to reflect the actual responsibilities of the Personnel Board, removing responsibilities that are now performed by different entities; and
- The amendment is intended to prevent conflicts of interest within Town government while aligning the Charter with constitutional requirements articulated in cases such as Broadrick v. Oklahoma, Magill v. Lynch, and Cranston Teachers Alliance Local No. 1704 AFT v. Miele.

⬭ **Approve**
⬭ **Reject**

Local Questions

8. DEPARTMENT OF FACILITIES AND CAPITAL ASSETS
(Article XV, § 12)

Shall the North Smithfield Home Rule Charter be amended to replace Section 12 of Article XV with a new Section, establishing a Department of Facilities and Capital Assets, headed by a Director of Facilities appointed by the Town Administrator, responsible for:

- Managing, maintaining, repairing, and planning all municipal buildings, grounds, and infrastructure;
- Developing a Capital Improvement Plan;
- Overseeing construction and renovation projects;
- Managing utilities and energy programs;
- Ensuring compliance with environmental standards;
- Preparing and administering the Department's operating budget; and to renumber the current Section 12 as Section 13?

Explanation:
This amendment would replace Section 12 of Article XV to establish a Department of Facilities and Capital Assets, headed by a Director of Facilities. The Department would provide professional oversight for:

- Maintenance, repair, and long-term planning of municipal buildings, grounds, and infrastructure;
- Capital projects, including construction and renovation;
- Utilities management, energy programs, and environmental compliance;
- Preparation and administration of the Department's operating budget.
- The amendment also renumbers the current Section 12 as Section 13 to maintain clear organization in the Charter.

⬭ **Approve**
⬭ **Reject**

Local Questions

9. BOARD OF CANVASSERS AND REGISTRATION
(Article II, § 11)

Shall Article II, Section 11 of the Home Rule Charter of the Town of North Smithfield be amended to provide that members of the Board of Canvassers and Registration are appointed by the Town Council rather than elected by the Town Council, in accordance with R.I. Gen. Laws § 17-8-1 requiring a bipartisan canvassing authority appointed by the municipal legislative body?

Explanation:
Currently, North Smithfield's Town Council "elects" members to the Board of Canvassers and Registration through an internal council vote. This amendment would change the process to "appointment" by the Town Council, which aligns with State law requirements. Under Rhode Island law, the Town Council must appoint a three-member bipartisan canvassing authority with no more than two members from the same political party (R.I. Gen. Law § 17-8-1). The Council President nominates candidates from lists submitted by political party committees, and the Town Council approves the appointments. This ensures proper bipartisan representation in election oversight and brings the Charter into compliance with state requirements.

⬭ **Approve**
⬭ **Reject**

10. TERMINOLOGY CORRECTION
(Article III, § 8(c))

Shall Article III, Section 8(c) of the Home Rule Charter of the Town of North Smithfield be amended by replacing the word "hiring" with the word "borrowing" in reference to the Town Council's authority to authorize tax anticipation notes and related municipal financing?

Explanation:
This is a simple word correction to fix an error in the Charter. The current Charter incorrectly uses the word "hiring" when describing the Town Council's authority to authorize tax anticipation notes and municipal financing. Since tax anticipation notes are a form of municipal borrowing, not hiring, the word should be "borrowing". This technical correction aligns the Charter language with the actual legal nature of these financial instruments and eliminates confusion.

⬭ **Approve**
⬭ **Reject**

Voting continues on back

Local Questions

11. ORDINANCE PUBLICATION AND ELECTRONIC NOTICE
(Article IV, § 9)

Shall Article IV, Section 9 of the Home Rule Charter of the Town of North Smithfield be amended to allow public notice of proposed ordinances and regulations to be published electronically on the Secretary of State's website in lieu of newspaper publication, in accordance with R.I. Gen. Laws § 45-6-1(c)?

Explanation:
Currently, when the town wants to adopt or change ordinances and regulations, it must publish advance notice in local newspapers. This amendment would allow the town to publish these notices electronically on the Secretary of State's official website instead of in newspapers. Rhode Island law specifically permits municipalities to use electronic notice on the Secretary of State's website in lieu of newspaper publication (R.I. Gen. Laws § 45-6-1(c)). This modernizes the notification process while maintaining public access to information about proposed local laws, and may reduce costs associated with newspaper publication requirements.

- ⬭ **Approve**
- ⬭ **Reject**

12. MUNICIPAL AUDIT REQUIREMENTS
(Article IV, § 10)

Shall Article IV, Section 10 of the Home Rule Charter of the Town of North Smithfield be amended to update municipal audit requirements to conform with R.I. Gen. Laws § 45-10-4, including requiring annual audits by independent certified public accountants and providing that selection of auditors is subject to approval by the Rhode Island Auditor General?

Explanation:
This amendment updates the charter to conform with current state audit requirements. Rhode Island law requires each municipality to hire independent certified public accountants to conduct detailed annual audits of the town's financial records (R.I. Gen. Laws § 45-10-4). The law also requires that the selection of auditors must receive final approval from the Rhode Island Auditor General before the town can enter into a contract for audit services (R.I. Gen. Laws § 45-10-4). This amendment ensures North Smithfield's Charter reflects these state-mandated audit procedures and oversight requirements.

- ⬭ **Approve**
- ⬭ **Reject**

Local Questions

13. PLANNING BOARD POWERS AND COMPREHENSIVE PLAN
(Article XII, § 2)

Shall Article XII, Section 2 of the Home Rule Charter of the Town of North Smithfield be amended to provide that the Planning Board's powers and duties include those set forth in R.I. Gen. Laws § 45-22-7, and to update public notice requirements for Comprehensive Plan adoption or amendment in accordance with R.I. Gen. Laws § 45-22.2-8, including expanded newspaper, municipal posting, and website notice requirements?

Explanation:
This amendment updates the Planning Board's powers and duties to include those specifically outlined in state law, and revises public notice requirements for adopting or amending the town's Comprehensive Plan. State law gives planning boards extensive responsibilities including preparing comprehensive plans, overseeing land development regulations, and conducting community studies. The amendment also updates notice requirements to comply with state law, which requires multiple forms of public notice including newspaper publication for three successive weeks, posting in municipal buildings, and website accessibility at least fourteen days before hearings.

- ⬭ **Approve**
- ⬭ **Reject**

14. SCHOOL COMMITTEE POWERS REFERENCE
(Article XIV, § 5)

Shall Article XIV, Section 5 of the Home Rule Charter of the Town of North Smithfield be amended to clarify that the powers and duties of the School Committee are in addition to those set forth in R.I. Gen. Laws § 16-2-9?

Explanation:
This amendment clarifies that the School Committee's powers and duties include those provided under state law. Rhode Island law gives school committees comprehensive authority over public school interests, including educational governance, personnel decisions, and financial management. However, there is an important legal consideration: under Rhode Island Supreme Court precedent, charter provisions affecting school committees may require express ratification by the General Assembly to be fully effective, since school committees are considered agents of the state rather than purely local bodies.

- ⬭ **Approve**
- ⬭ **Reject**

Local Questions

15. ETHICS PROVISIONS UPDATE
(Article XVI, § 8)

Shall Article XVI, Section 8 of the Home Rule Charter of the Town of North Smithfield be amended to replace existing local ethics provisions with a requirement that all town officials and employees comply with the Rhode Island Code of Ethics, R.I. Gen. Laws § 36-14-1 et seq.?

Explanation:
This amendment would replace any existing local ethics provisions in the charter with a requirement that all town officials and employees comply with the Rhode Island Code of Ethics. The state Code of Ethics already applies to all municipal officials and employees, requiring adherence to high ethical standards, avoiding conflicts of interest, and not using public positions for private gain. This amendment would eliminate potentially conflicting local ethics rules and ensure the town operates under the uniform statewide ethics standards that apply to all Rhode Island municipalities.

- ⬭ **Approve**
- ⬭ **Reject**